

ICICI Bank website It's an India-specific calculator that helps you keep a track of your carbon footprint produced by activities such as travelling, electricity consumption and number of LPG cylinders used per month

► **Carbonfootprint.com**

<http://dgit.in/PSOOuo>

Third in the list is a very comprehensive yet simple calculator that takes various parameters into consideration to estimate your footprint. It may take some time to input the values into the system but the greater the detail, the better the estimate! The results may vary from software to software though depending on the detail accepted by the system but you'll get a rough idea of your footprint. The system takes into account your household electricity and fossil fuel usage, flight, car, motorbike and public transport usage and secondary carbon contributors such as food preferences, imported goods preferences and the amount you recycle.

Carbon Footprint – The old school way

If you want to do it the way your mom does it with a pen and paper – maybe because like her, you have trust issues when it comes to using software – run to your study desk and get a pen, paper and your last year's bills. Once all your greenhouse gas contributing bills are in place (this would include electricity bills and natural gas bills or gas cylinder bills, among others) estimate the number of kilowatts of electricity that you use in a month. Each kilowatt of electricity produces approximately one kilogram of carbon dioxide. To find out the carbon footprint of your vehicle, find out the number of kilometres or miles you drove in the past year. This will give you the number of gallons or litres of fuel that you used in a year. When you multiply the number of gallons by nine, you get the kilograms of carbon dioxide that your vehicle produces in a year. Note that 1 US gallon is equal to 3.79 litres.

Next in line is your footprint produced by airplane travel. To calculate this, all you need to do is total up the number of miles that you travelled by air in the past year (this data is available on your ticket). Once you get the total air miles travelled, multiply this number by 0.23. This will give you the number of kilograms of carbon dioxide emission. When you've figured out the number of carbon dioxide emissions for each of these activities, calculate the total of the kilograms of carbon dioxide emissions. Now, divide this value by 1,000. This will give you the metric tons of CO₂ emissions by